



St Augustine's Catholic Primary School and Nursery

WRITING STATEMENT OF INTENT

Intent

At St Augustine's we are working hard to provide our children with rich and varied learning opportunities that help them to become confident and enthusiastic learners. Throughout the school we aim for the children to develop an awareness of the audience, purpose and context when writing. We ensure meaningful and purposeful writing tasks are planned, to give a reason for writing. As a school we use a Mastery and text-based approach to writing to ensure progressive and systematic teaching of skills across the curriculum. Throughout each year and across the school these skills are repeated to ensure children are able master and apply these skills independently. Writing is taught through high-quality picture books incorporating fiction and non-fiction. Teachers also carefully choose and weave in high quality texts across all subjects to support and develop children's vocabulary and encourage children to make cross curricular links. Across the school, children use the skills learnt in their English lessons and apply these in their topic writing. Across the school, spelling and grammar sessions are weaved into each unit within the English lessons. In Key Stage 2 children also have standalone spelling and grammar lessons. 'Talk for Writing' is incorporated into our English curriculum in order to allow children to become story tellers and makers. Children enjoy book talk which allows them to explore personal and collective responses to a text. Children orally rehearse stories and perform them to the rest of the class. This then supports children in the writing process, especially in EYFS and Key Stage 1 when they are asked to modify and innovate stories to make them their own. At St Augustine's we want our children to have a positive attitude towards writing, to be able to independently express their emotions



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and share their ideas. When the time comes our children leave us we want them to be able to write as authors and poets and have developed a life-long love for writing.

Implementation

At St Augustine's we want all of our pupils to be capable readers, writers, spellers and speakers, who can transfer their English skills to other curriculum subjects and who are prepared for the next steps in their education. Our English lessons develop pupils' spoken language, reading, writing, grammar and vocabulary. Writing is taught through a mastery approach, where the children are taught skills progressively and systematically. These skills are repeated to ensure children are able to master and apply these skills independently. We teach our pupils to speak clearly, to convey their ideas fluently and confidently and to ask questions. We know the value of excellent vocabulary and this is developed and practised across our curriculum. In EYFS and Key Stage 1 we use 'Talk for Writing' to encourage pupils to express their ideas, discuss their ideas and to develop more sophisticated vocabulary. We develop writing skills and have built in repetition within our units so that our children have the stamina and ability to write at the age expected standard by the end of the year. To support children in moving towards independent writing we provide a wide range of activities including the use of film and imagery, music, ICT, modelled, shared and guided writing, peer assessment and discussion. We provide varied and exciting opportunities for writing for purpose and we encourage pupils to see themselves as authors and poets. We promote the importance of written work by providing a writing purpose and opportunities for children's writing to be read aloud and listened to by an audience. Across the school writing is taught daily. Early writing is taught through early mark making, then when the children begin RWI phonics they are taught the letter formations. This begins with writing (whether with a writing tool or in the air) CVC words, moving onto short sentences using the sounds they have been taught. The children are also encouraged to write independently in continuous provision. In Key Stage 1 this is then developed and handwriting sessions are regularly incorporated into the English lessons as well as RWI phonics. In Key Stage 2 handwriting is incorporated into weekly English lessons and standalone daily 10 minute lessons. Spelling and grammar is taught throughout each English unit across the school. In Key Stage 2 standalone daily lessons are also taught for 15 minutes (3 grammar and 2 spelling lessons).

Impact

At St Augustine's we measure the effectiveness and impact of our English Writing, Grammar and Spelling curriculum in a variety of different ways. Assessment for learning strategies are used on a daily basis. These will allow a picture to be built up of the pupils' progress, any areas of strength or weakness which can then be addressed in teachers' planning accordingly. We use National and summative testing to assess pupils' outcomes for Grammar, Punctuation and Spelling as part of the Statutory Assessment Tests (SATs for Year 2 and Year 6 pupils) and through termly summative assessments across school which enables pupils' progress and



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attainment in the subject matter to be evaluated. Additionally, pupils complete writing assessments on a half termly basis, where written work is assessed to inform teachers of pupils' next steps and successes. Half-termly, teacher's also moderate pupils work in school and in cluster meetings with other schools to ensure accurate assessments are being made across the school. The quality of writing in English and knowledge books is evaluated by drop ins, pupil interviews, conversations with teachers and work scrutinies. These inform future areas for improvement and the impact of new initiatives.

OVERVIEW

~~Clubs can develop and manage a Club scholarship program using District Grants or alternatively using its own funds. This policy covers the use of District Grants for scholarships.~~

~~Factors to consider are:~~

- ~~• Who will manage the application process for scholarships funded by district grants.~~
- ~~• What types of scholarships will be offered.~~
- ~~• Determine and communicate the eligibility requirements for the scholarships.~~
- ~~• Define and publicize the application and selection process as early as possible.~~
- ~~• Determine what reporting you will require of scholars.~~
- ~~• Help scholars prepare for their scholarship experiences.~~
- ~~• Determine how the funds will be transferred to the scholar.~~
- ~~• Establish a procedure for obtaining receipts for expenses covered by the scholarship and communicate it clearly to scholars.~~

MANAGING THE PROCESS

~~Clubs may want to set up a scholarships subcommittee, perhaps under the Youth Services Committee. Clubs may enlist the services of another organization to help with the process. For example, an organization which helps low-income students prepare for college application and enrollment may be used to provide a pool of applicants for the scholarships based upon the eligibility requirements set by the club. Rotarians must be actively involved in the selection process. Any fees charged by that organization cannot be funded by the District Grant.~~

DECIDING TYPES OF SCHOLARSHIPS



Clubs may consider many types of scholarships, such as:

- Location of studies (county, District, state, U.S., foreign).
- Level and/or type of studies (secondary, vocational, undergraduate, graduate).
- Length of the study program (one semester, one academic year, full undergraduate or graduate degree program).
- Field of study, research or vocational training.
- Basis for funding (financial need, merit, or a combination of the two).
- Amount of scholarship award (fixed, within a range, open amount based upon the application).



Clubs may set certain responsibilities and expectations that applicants should be made aware of. These might include:

- Make presentations at Club meetings and events, both before and after the study program.
- Submit a written report or keep an online journal to document their achievements and experiences or to give feedback about the scholarship.
- Become involved with Rotary in the community where they will study by attending Rotary Club meetings, speaking to Rotaract clubs or participating in service projects.

SETTING ELIGIBILITY REQUIREMENTS

Clubs determine the eligibility requirements for scholarships funded by a District Grant. Typical requirements may include:

- Minimum academic level and performance.
- Financial need. For example, an income below a certain level.
- Geographic location. This may be either a residency or full-time work or study within an area.
- Strong public speaking and interpersonal skills.
- High ethical standards demonstrated in their personal, academic or professional lives.
- Knowledge of local, regional, national and international current events.

Scholarships funded by District Grants cannot be awarded to anyone in the following categories:

- Rotarians, including honorary Rotarians.
- Employees of Rotary Clubs, Districts or other Rotary entities, or of Rotary International.
- Spouses, lineal descendants (children or grandchildren by blood, legal adoption, or marriage without adoption), spouses of lineal descendants, or ancestors (parents or grandparents by blood) of persons in the above categories.



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- ~~• Employees of agencies, organizations, or institutions that partner with the Rotary Foundation or Rotary International.~~
- ~~• Former Rotarians and honorary Rotarians who have terminated their membership within the preceding 36 months.~~
- ~~• Persons who were ineligible based on their familial relationship to a former Rotarian or honorary Rotarian, for a period of 36 months after termination of their family's membership.~~

~~All eligibility requirements that are set must conform to all antidiscrimination laws in effect in California.~~



DEFINING THE APPLICATION AND SELECTION PROCESS

The Club decides what documentation applicants must provide and specifies how applicants may submit their application materials. The club should identify and share the contact information for a Rotarian who will answer questions about the scholarship, the deadline, and the application process. The club should establish a selection committee and ensure that members have no actual or perceived conflicts of interest. Notification procedures should be established as part of the process.

SETTING REPORTING REQUIREMENTS

Clubs are required to collect and retain receipts from the scholar for expenses of \$75 or more for a minimum of five years.

ISSUING SCHOLARSHIP FUNDS

The Club may choose to transfer the scholarship funds directly to the scholar or to the organization assisting with the scholarship program which in turn will direct the funds to the scholar.

The Club may issue the scholarship funds in installments, to ensure that any reporting requirements are met or to simply assist the scholar with budgeting. If the scholarship will be paid in installments, clearly communicate when they should expect to receive the disbursements and the amount of each disbursement.

CLOSING GRANTS

The District 5150 Final or Interim District Grant Report is to be submitted as required. If Clubs require any additional reports such as written assessments of their experiences or academic transcripts, it should collect these as soon after the end of the scholarship term as is reasonable. As scholars approach the end of their studies, it is useful to discuss how the Club plans to continue to involve them as Rotary Alumni.